RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

22 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 2:46 PM, Thursday 22 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 126 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 53 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 15,450 minutes at 3:00 PM; three permitted takeoffs at 1:40 to 1:52 PM; Dammam moving, no open halt

INCIDENT SUMMARY

1 What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 15,450 minutes at 3:00 PM; NOTAM A3650/26 still requires prior GACA permission for every flight**.
- Three permitted Riyadh takeoffs since 12:00 PM, the first since Wednesday: non-airline HZA2 to Paris 1:40 PM, Saudia SV978 to Guangzhou 1:46 PM and non-airline HZCMJ to Farnborough 1:52 PM; no landings.
- 126 Riyadh flights cancelled so far on Thursday (29%).
- Coalition intercepted 1 drone over the Riyadh region at 11:55 AM and 4 more over the Riyadh and Madinah regions at 2:33 PM; no damage or casualties reported.
- Dammam airport moving: 11 takeoffs and 8 landings since 12:00 PM, latest Biman BG350 to Dhaka 2:42 PM; a 54-minute gap from 11:25 AM to 12:19 PM has closed, no open halt.
- Gulf markets fell on the fresh strikes (Reuters); Egypt, Jordan and India condemned the Dammam airport attack.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (15437 min).

126	2/0	2
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

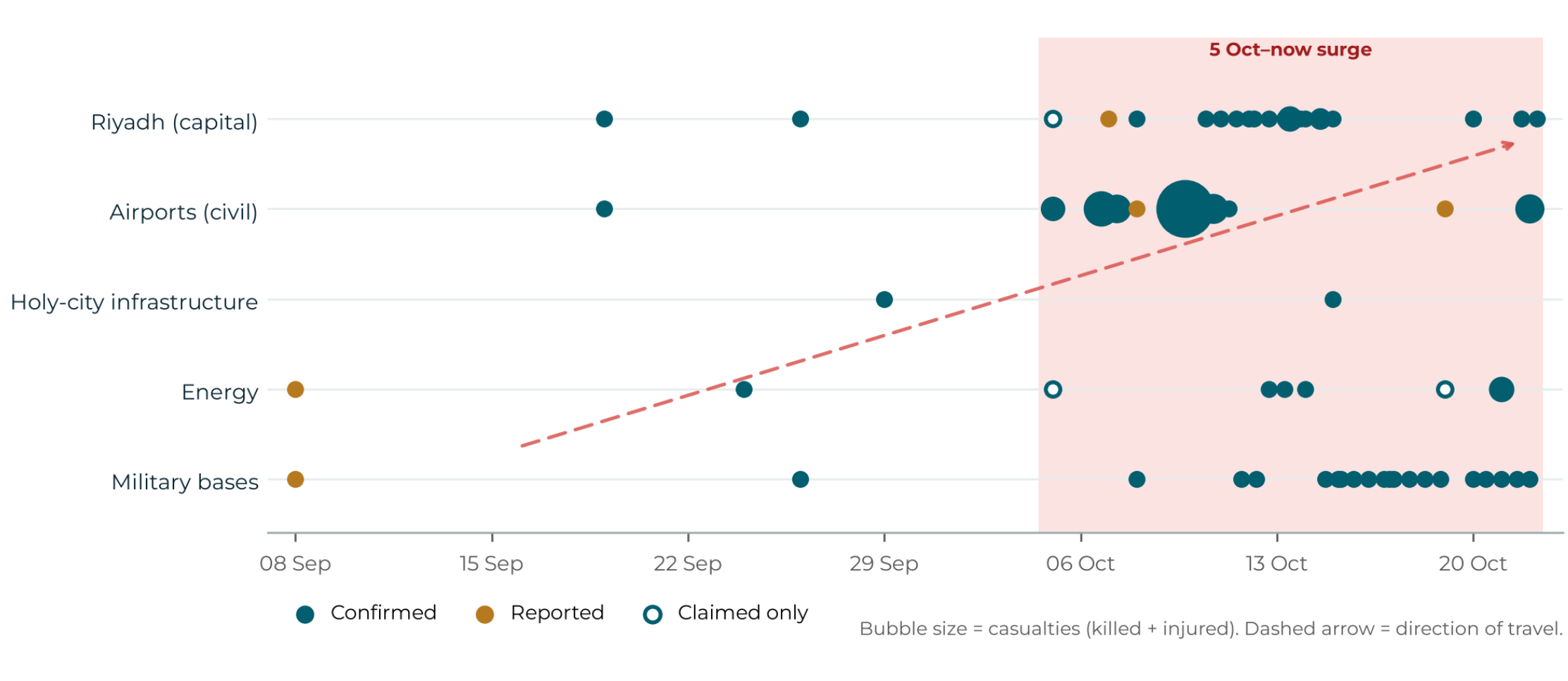
5 takeoffs and 5 landings in the last hour.

53	5/5	1
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (15,450 min at 3:00 PM); 3 permitted takeoffs (HZA2 1:40 PM, SV978 1:46 PM, HZCMJ 1:52 PM), 0 landings since 12:00 PM
- Dammam: 11 takeoffs and 8 landings since 12:00 PM; 54-minute gap 11:25 AM to 12:19 PM, now closed
- Coalition: 1 drone intercepted over the Riyadh region (11:55 AM) and 4 over the Riyadh and Madinah regions (2:33 PM)
- UK Defence Ministry and Egypt, Jordan and India statements on the Houthi attacks; Gulf markets down (Reuters)

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 22 OCT



62 sourced events since 8 September (54 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: four drones intercepted and destroyed over the Riyadh and Madinah regions; targets and casualties not stated (22 Oct, Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA; none reported). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

2 Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 12:00 PM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED INTERCEPTION **2:33 PM AST · Riyadh**

Four drones intercepted and destroyed over the Riyadh and Madinah regions; targets and casualties not stated.
Coalition spokesman / SPA · none reported

Last 24 hours: Attacks 1, interceptions 5, casualty reports 1.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

3 Coalition intercepts 5 drones over Riyadh and Madinah regions; Riyadh airport still halted; Dammam operating

Checked at 2:50 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED DMM **Egypt, Jordan and India condemn the Houthi attack on Dammam's King Fahd airport**
SPA / Al Ekhbariya · **2:39 PM** · SPA 1:44, 1:57 and 2:39 PM; Al Ekhbariya (India) 1:42 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 2:50 PM

SPA carried statements from Egypt and Jordan condemning the attack on King Fahd International Airport in Dammam (translated from Arabic). India condemned continuing attacks on Saudi civilian and energy infrastructure, naming the Dammam airport and the Shaybah field, and said they must stop immediately.

CONFIRMED **Reuters: Gulf markets fall as fresh Houthi strikes on Saudi Arabia raise regional risk**
Reuters · **2:35 PM** · published 2:35 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 2:50 PM

Reuters reports Gulf stock markets fell on Thursday as the new Houthi strikes on Saudi Arabia raised perceived regional risk.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: 4 drones intercepted and destroyed over the Riyadh and Madinah regions**
Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA / Al Ekhbariya · **2:33 PM** · published 2:33 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 2:50 PM

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki al-Malki said four drones were intercepted and destroyed over the Riyadh and Madinah regions (translated from Arabic). No targets, damage or casualties were stated.

CONFIRMED **UK Defence Ministry says it observed Houthi attacks on Saudi infrastructure and airports that caused casualties**
Arab News / Al Arabiya English · **12:54 PM** · published 12:54 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 2:50 PM

The UK Defence Ministry said it had observed Houthi attacks on Saudi infrastructure and airports resulting in casualties, and that the military support it announced is meant to help Saudi Arabia at this critical moment.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed in the Riyadh region**
Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA · **11:55 AM** · published 11:55 AM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 2:50 PM; SPA English 12:18 PM

The coalition said a drone was intercepted and destroyed in the Riyadh region (translated from Arabic). No damage or casualties were reported.

CONFIRMED DMM **Al Ekhbariya: GACA announces Dammam airport is operating again and air traffic is back to normal**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **11:07 AM** · published 11:07 AM AST Thu 22 Oct (Arabic, translated); checked 11:55 AM

Saudi state channel Al Ekhbariya reported GACA's announcement that King Fahd International Airport in Dammam has resumed operations and that air traffic has returned to normal after the attack.

CONFIRMED DMM **GACA follow-up: Dammam airport attack death toll rises to 2 killed, 8 injured; operations resumed and traffic back to normal**
GACA (@ksagaca) / SPA (@Spa_Eng) / Al Ekhbariya · **9:38 AM** · GACA statement published 9:38 AM AST Thu 22 Oct (Arabic), SPA English 10:01 AM, GACA English 11:29 AM; Al Ekhbariya 9:45 AM and 9:51 AM; checked 11:55 AM

GACA said the death toll from Wednesday evening's attack on King Fahd International Airport in Dammam has risen to two, a Saudi citizen and an Indian resident, with 8 injured (3 Saudis, 2 Indians, 2 Yemenis and 1 Nepali). It said airport operations have resumed and air traffic has returned to normal.

CONFIRMED **King Khalid airport still tells passengers to follow official authorities and their airline for airspace updates**
King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **8:47 AM** · replies published 7:07 AM and 8:47 AM AST Thu 22 Oct (Arabic, translated); checked 8:55 AM

Replying to passengers, KKIA again said the latest airspace updates come from the official authorities and the airline the booking was made with. No reopening time was given.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: four drones intercepted and destroyed over the Eastern Region**
Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA · **1:04 AM** · published 1:04 AM AST Thu 22 Oct (Arabic; SPA English 1:14 AM); checked 2:55 AM

The coalition spokesman said four drones were intercepted and destroyed in the Eastern Region. Targets, debris and casualties were not stated.

CONFIRMED **Energy Ministry: the two killed by Shaybah drone debris were Filipino and Nepali nationals; the injured are Pakistani and Indian**
Ministry of Energy via SPA / AP / GMA News · **10:08 PM** · ministry statement Wed 21 Oct; GMA News published 8:08 AM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 8:55 AM

The Energy Ministry named the nationalities of the casualties from Wednesday morning's intercepted drone at Aramco's Shaybah field: a Filipino and a Nepali killed, a Pakistani and an Indian injured. Operations were not affected.

CONFIRMED **Ministry of Energy: drone aimed at a Shaybah field facility intercepted; falling debris killed 2 residents and injured 2**
SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **10:08 PM** · published 10:08 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (official account; Arabic SPA 9:57 PM); checked 11:55 PM

The Ministry of Energy said air defences intercepted a drone on Wednesday morning that tried to target a facility at Aramco's Shaybah field in the Eastern Province. Falling debris killed two residents (a Filipino and a Nepali) and injured two (a Pakistani and an Indian), and a contractor's vehicle caught fire outside the facility.

CONFIRMED **US State Department orders non-emergency staff and families to leave Saudi Arabia**
Reuters / US State Department spokesperson · **9:57 PM** · Reuters published 9:57 PM AST Wed 21 Oct; BBC and AP followed; checked 8:55 AM Thu

State Department spokesperson Tommy Pigott said non-emergency US government employees and their family members in Saudi Arabia only were ordered to depart, citing Houthi attacks on civilian airports and critical infrastructure. Four US officials told Reuters that family members at other US Gulf missions will also be withdrawn.

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

4 Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (15437 min).

126	1:52 PM	10:49 PM	2	2
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
53 departures + 73 arrivals, 29% of 440 scheduled.	HZCMJ to Farnborough (non-airline flight), 54 min before 2:46 PM. Last airline: SV978, 1:46 PM.	SV993 from Shenzhen, 957 min before 2:46 PM.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Jeddah, Madinah.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 2:46 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 124 at 2:46 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**53**	**73**	**126**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**53 (24%)**	**71 (32%)**	**124**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**3 (1%)**	**1 (0%)**	**4**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**1 (25%)**	**3 (75%)**	**4**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**60 min**	**0 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**3 of 123**	**0 of 108**	**3 of 231**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**2**	**2**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**29**	**30**	**59**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**181**	**195**	**376**	FR24 stats panel

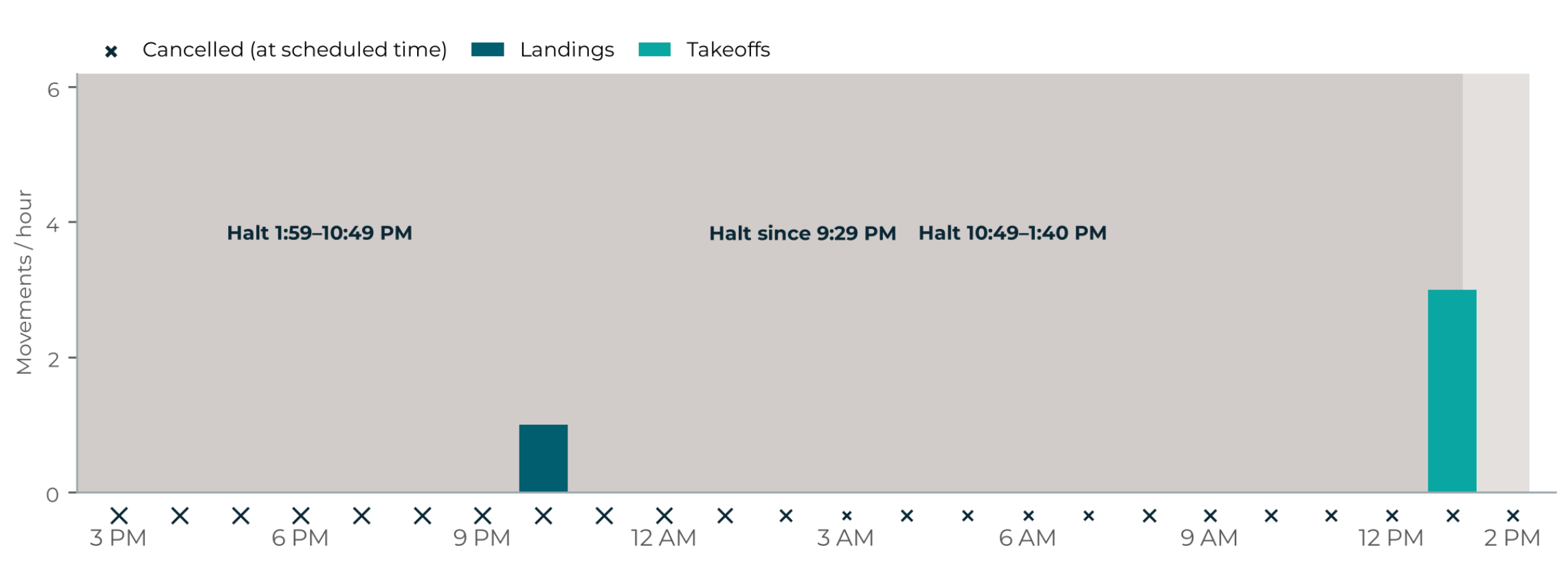
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	54
flynas	19
Gulf Air	10
flyadeal	9
Royal Jordanian	8

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Jeddah	48
Madinah	15
Dubai	12
Bahrain	12
Amman	7

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



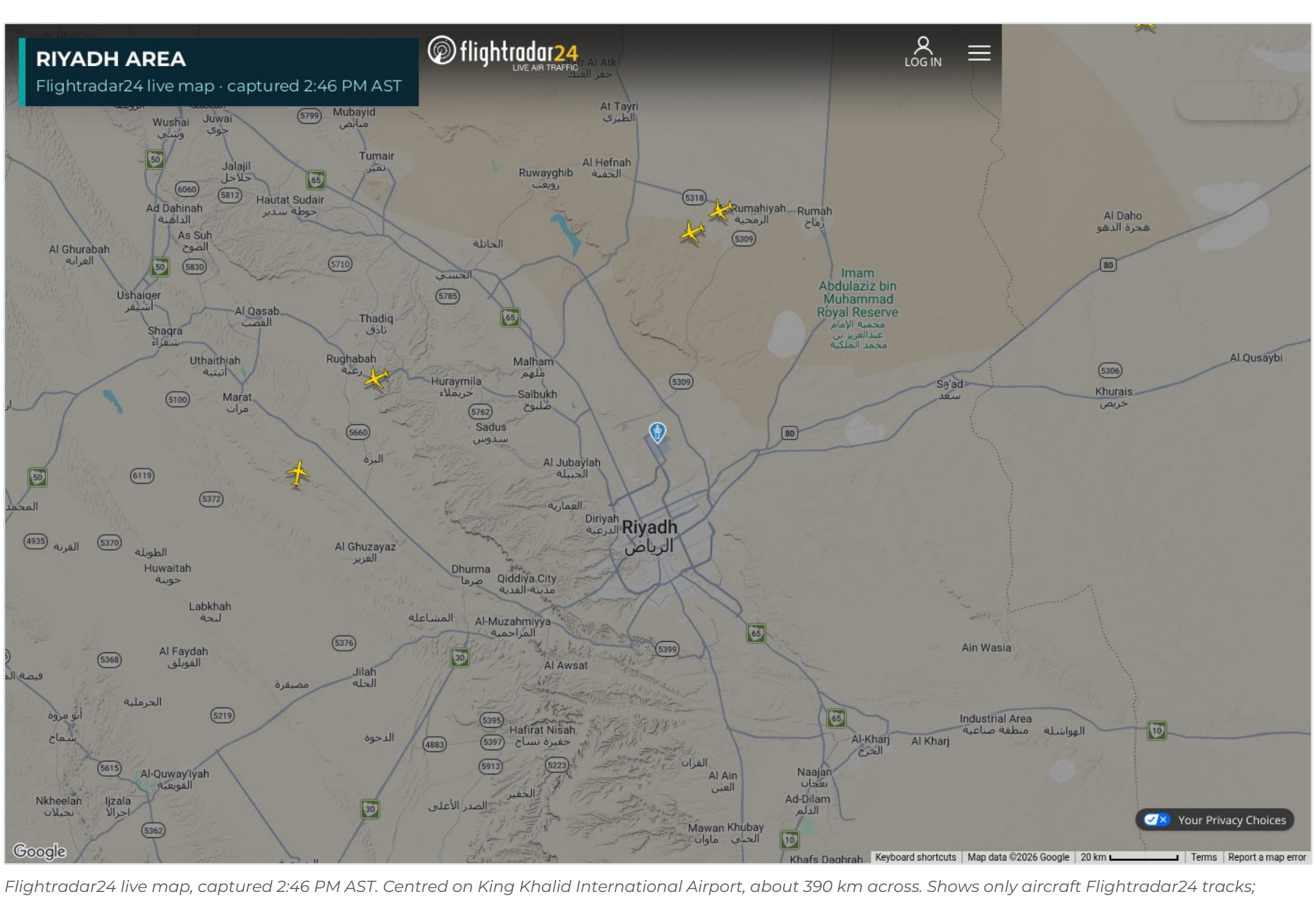
Recorded takeoffs (3) and landings (1) at RUH per hour from 3:00 PM Wednesday to 2:46 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movements in it are the delayed Saudia SV993 landing at 10:49 PM Wednesday and three permitted takeoffs at 1:40, 1:46 and 1:52 PM today. Dammam's halts in the window ran 8:54–9:48 PM, 9:56–10:55 PM, 11:17 PM–3:07 AM, 3:07–5:53 AM, 6:47–7:33 AM and 11:25 AM–12:19 PM; none is open.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 10:49–1:40 PM	890 min
Halt 1:59–10:49 PM	530 min
OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	15437 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 2:46 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

5 Dammam airport: disrupted. 5 takeoffs and 5 landings in the last hour.

53	2:42 PM	2:39 PM	5	1
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
26 departures + 27 arrivals, 21% of 258 scheduled.	BG350 to Dhaka, 4 min before 2:46 PM.	F3309 from Jeddah, 6 min before 2:46 PM.	5 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Madinah.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 2:46 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 52 at 2:46 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**26**	**27**	**53**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**26 (20%)**	**26 (19%)**	**52**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**24 (18%)**	**23 (17%)**	**47**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**6 (20%)**	**11 (32%)**	**17**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**30 min**	**111 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**25 of 66**	**24 of 69**	**49 of 135**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**1**	**1**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**4**	**7**	**11**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**35**	**39**	**74**	FR24 stats panel

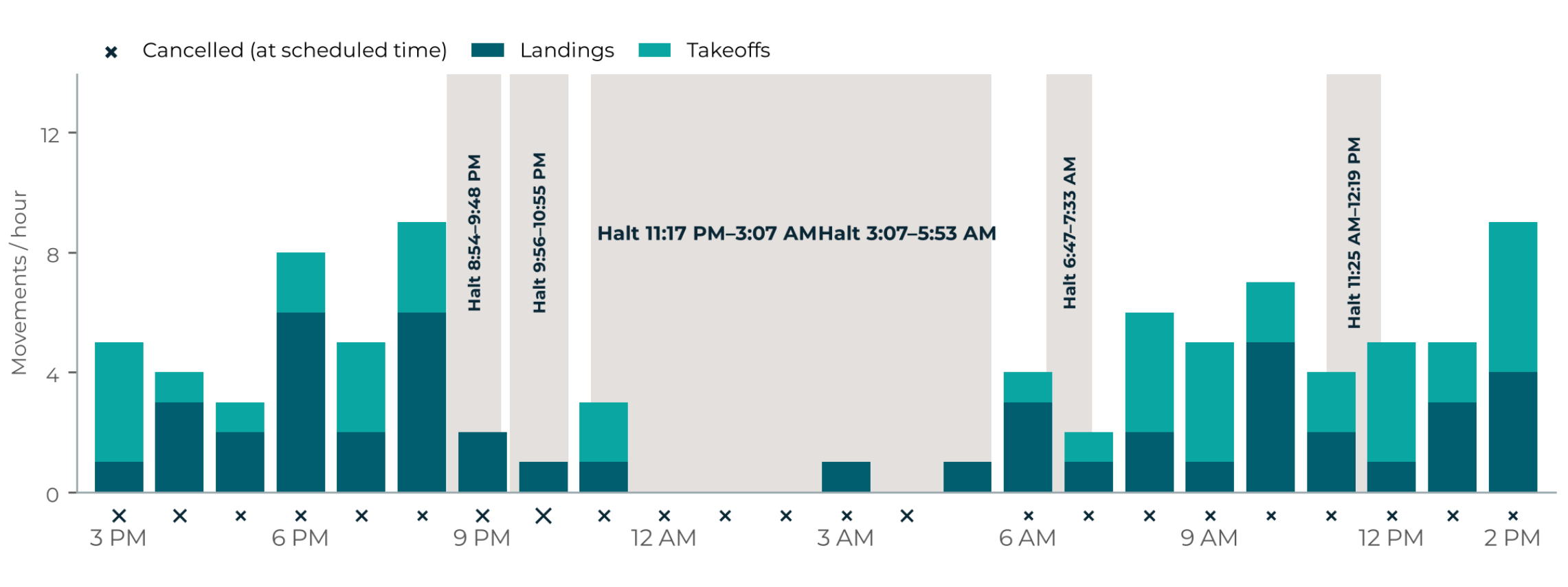
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Emirates	8
Etihad Airways	8
flydubai	8
Saudia	6
Egyptair	6

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Dubai	16
Jeddah	9
Abu Dhabi	8
Cairo	6
Istanbul	3

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (41) and landings (48) at DMM per hour from 3:00 PM Wednesday to 2:46 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 11:25 AM–12:19 PM	54 min
Halt 6:47–7:33 AM	46 min
Halt 3:07–5:53 AM	166 min
Halt 11:17 PM–3:07 AM	230 min
Halt 9:56–10:55 PM	58 min

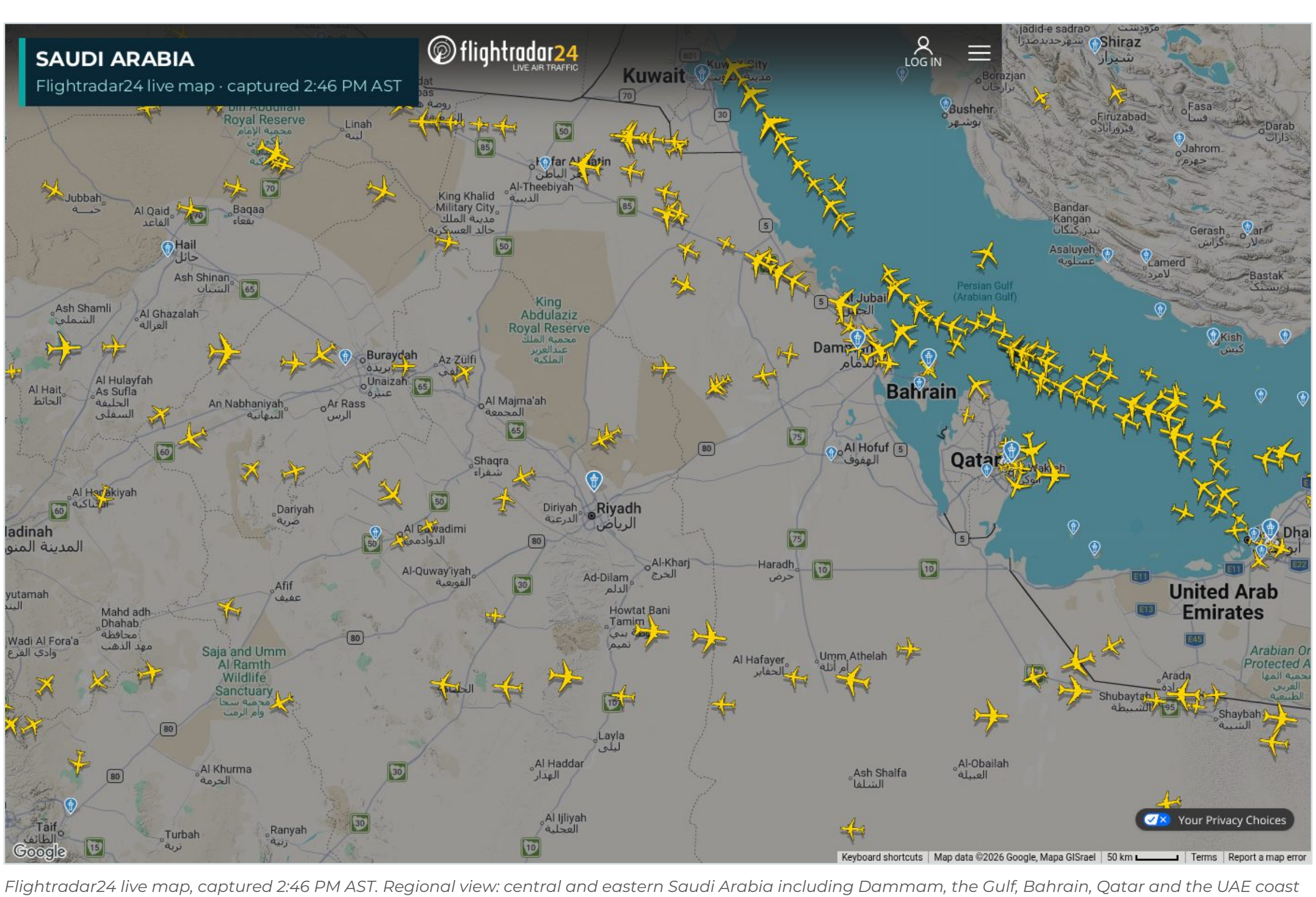
DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

CONFIRMED **Egypt, Jordan and India condemn the Houthi attack on Dammam's King Fahd airport** (SPA / Al Ekhbariya · 2:39 PM)

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: GACA announces Dammam airport is operating again and air traffic is back to normal** (Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · 11:07 AM)

CONFIRMED **GACA follow-up: Dammam airport attack death toll rises to 2 killed, 8 injured; operations resumed and traffic back to normal** (GACA (@ksagaca) / SPA (@Spa_Eng) / Al Ekhbariya · 9:38 AM)

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



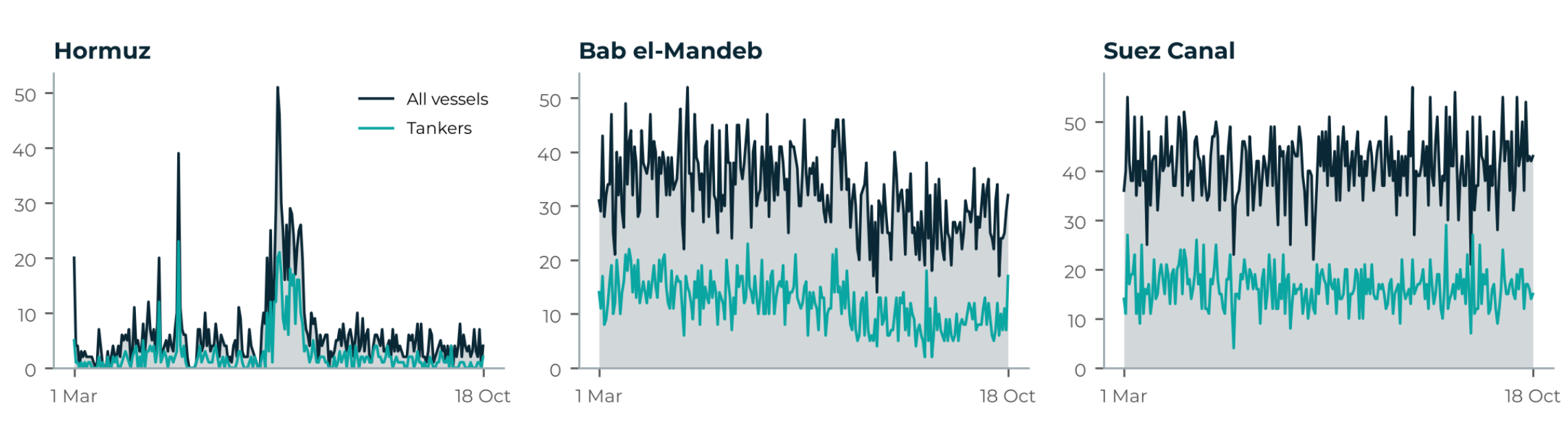
Flightradar24 live map, captured 2:46 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

ECONOMY

6 Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

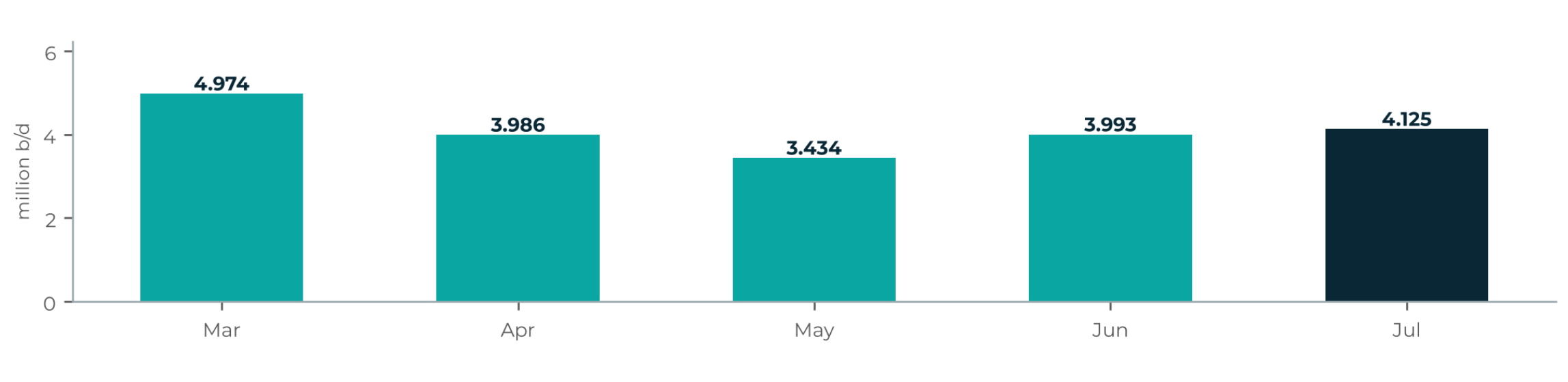
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 18 Oct	**4**	2	2	3.7 (4.1)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 18 Oct	**32**	17	15	26.4 (28.3)
Suez Canal	Sun 18 Oct	**43**	15	28	44.3 (41.7)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 2:47 PM, Thu 22 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

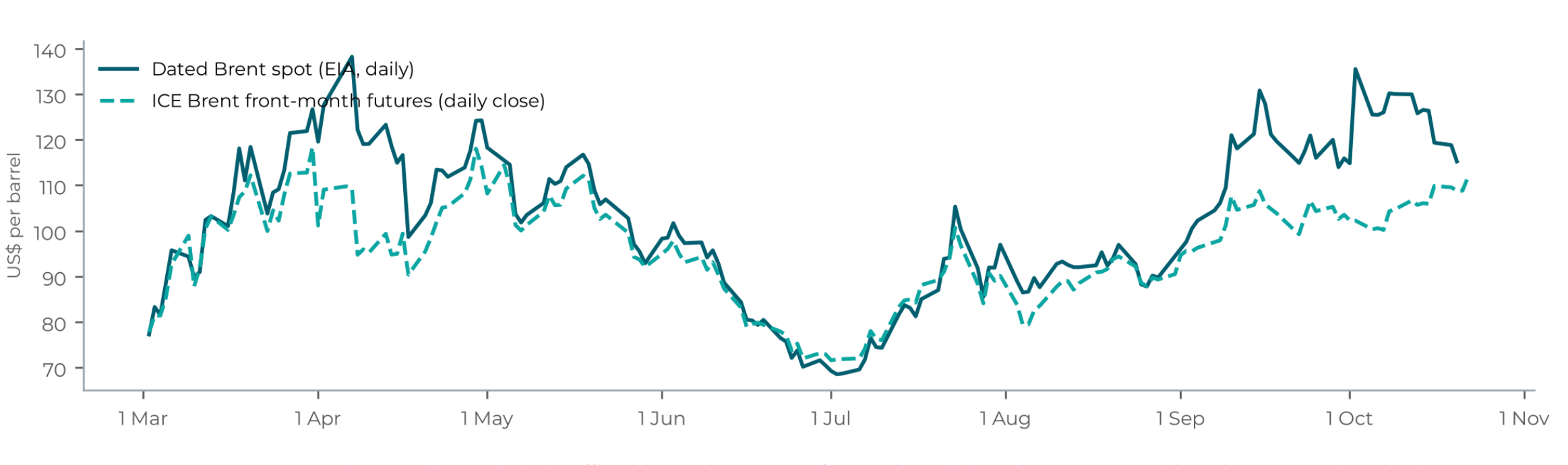


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$111.90	$115.22	-4%	+49%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 2:37 PM, Thu 22 Oct AST (+2.8% on day). Near real time.	Tue 20 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $119.66 on Fri 18 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

METHOD AND LIMITS

7 What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 2:46 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
2:46 PM, Thu 22 Oct	2:46 PM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	6:00 PM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 6:00 PM